INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

HALF OF BUYERS NEVER CALL A SECOND AGENT.

The first call is not a warm-up. It is the interview.

D.J. Paris
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41% OF BUYERS HIRE AN AGENT AFTER EXACTLY ONE CONVERSATION.

Zillow surveyed about 10,200 buyers. There is often no round two.

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MOST AGENTS TREAT THE FIRST CALL LIKE SMALL TALK. THE NUMBERS SAY IT'S THE WHOLE DECISION.

Zillow's 2025 Consumer Housing Trends Report found that among buyers who contacted at least one agent, 50% hired the first one they talked to, up from 47% the two years before. 41% hired after a single conversation. The usual playbook, send a few listings and follow up later, assumes there will be a later. For roughly half of buyers, there isn't one.

WHAT YOU DO ON THAT FIRST CALL:

1 **Answer it fast.**
Half the time, being second means you never get a turn at all.

2 **Treat it as the interview, not the intro.**
The buyer may already be deciding while you're still warming up.

3 **Ask for the meeting on that call.**
Don't default to "I'll send you some listings" and wait for them to call back.

4 **Stop scripting a slow follow-up sequence for a decision that often happens once.**

THE TAKEAWAY

ANSWER FAST. ASK FOR THE MEETING ON THE FIRST CALL. DON'T WAIT FOR ROUND TWO.

That first conversation is the interview, whether you treat it that way or not.

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